

TAB 27



Board of Education Report

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Ms. Gonez - Celebrating Latino Heritage Month in the Los Angeles Unified School District (Res 004-23/24)
(For Action September 12, 2023)

Whereas, The United States has observed Latino Heritage Month from September 15 to October 15 since 1988 to commemorate the contributions, heritage, achievements, and cultural influences of Latino Americans in the United States;

Whereas, Latino Heritage Month also recognizes the intersectionality and diversity of the U.S. Latino population, incorporating indigenous histories and celebrating the independence days of several Latin American countries including: Costa Rica, El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, and Nicaragua;

Whereas, This month-long recognition serves as an opportunity for all Americans to learn more about Latino history, promote cultural awareness and inclusivity, and celebrate diversity both in the present and in our nation's history;

Whereas, The U.S. Latino population has grown to become the second largest racial or ethnic group in the United States in the last decade, reaching 62.6 million Latinos as of 2021 and accounting for 19% of all Americans;

Whereas, The state of California is home to the largest Latino population in the country, where they comprise 40.3% of the state's overall population, and almost 50% of the population of the County of Los Angeles;

Whereas, Latino students comprise almost 78% of the Los Angeles Unified District student population, underscoring the importance and relevance of Latino Heritage Month among the District's students and families;

Whereas, Recognizing and celebrating Latino Heritage Month as a District furthers the work of our Strategic Plan to provide culturally relevant, empowering curriculum that inspires students to become leaders and advocates for their communities; and

Whereas, The District is committed, above and beyond this commemoration, to empowering students through culturally responsive and inclusive learning environments that celebrates the value and diversity of all its students; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District hereby recognizes and celebrates September 15 through October 15 as Latino Heritage Month;

Resolved further, That the Office of the Superintendent will work to promote educational resources on Latino history, culture, and heritage and make them widely available to staff, students, and families online through the District homepage and social media accounts; and, be it finally

Resolved, That by adoption of this resolution, the Board and Superintendent hereby encourage all students, staff, and families, to commemorate and celebrate the immense historical and cultural contributions that Latino people have made and continue to make here in Los Angeles, California, and the United States.